



35th anniversary of blade runner

On June 25th an iconic sci-fi classic directed by Ridley Scott turned 35. The sequel Bladerunner 2049 releases Oct 6. <http://dgit.in/30BR2049>



Snowden-inspired leaks in CIA

Disclosure of secret intelligence accelerated after revelations made by Edward Snowden says the CIA director. <http://dgit.in/LeakUp>

OnePlus 5

A speed demon, but no flagship killer

If you are looking for pure performance (speed), a near-stock Android experience and bang for the buck in premium Android smartphone, there's nothing better than the OnePlus 5. But, the OnePlus 5 doesn't come across as a flagship killer. Android flagships of 2017 have shifted gears in terms of looks and feature set, and the newest from OnePlus does fall a bit short in those departments.

Design and looks: Starting with the looks, build and design. OnePlus 5 is a good-looking smartphone that does feel premium and well-crafted in every sense. Having said that, the Samsung Galaxy S8 and the LG G6 make the OnePlus 5 look a little dated in the looks and design department. Simply put, while the OnePlus 5 is a well-made device that does feel premium enough for its price tag, it doesn't look as sharp and appealing when standing next to the 2017 Android flagships. As far as the 5.5-inch display goes, the PenTile RGBG AMOLED display on the OnePlus 5 treads on the borderline of adequate sharpness needed for a 5.5-inch device. The 5.5-inch IPS RGBW display on the iPhone 7 Plus, for example, feels visibly sharper at the same 1080p resolution.

Overall, the display sharpness on the OnePlus 5 is fine and does not leave you wanting. It's only when you hold a QHD screen based phone next to it, that you start discerning and realizing the difference.

Performance: Plonk the fastest available SoC on a 1080p device, layer it with stock Android goodness and optimise the living daylight out of it. What you get is a OnePlus 5. Sure, they went a wee bit too far on the optimising bit, making the phone perform at break neck speeds on benchmarks



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when it is supposed to behave closer to real world performance. But, that by no means can take away the fact that the OnePlus 5 is the fastest Android phone in the market today, not just in terms of synthetic benchmarks but how it feels and performs on regular usage. From app load times, to multitasking, browsing and heavy gaming, the OnePlus 5 makes light of everything you throw at it. And yes, we never encountered any serious heat issues with the device.

Camera: OnePlus flagships have never managed to lead and set an example on the imaging front. At 1/2.8" (6.4mm), the 16MP Sony IMX398 sensor powering the main camera is close but no cigar in terms of sheer sensor size or even the pixel size (1.12

µm). It is however, a dual-pixel sensor, making it a lot more capable in terms of focusing speed and accuracy. OnePlus has put more focus on the lens than the sensor, with a large f/1.7 aperture, the OnePlus 5 is evidently better equipped to deal with low light situations in comparison to the OnePlus 3T, or for that matter many of the previous gen flagships. But, the biggest win for OnePlus 5 camera, in our books, would be the speed of capture, the focusing system, scene evaluation algorithms and image processing engine. Heading to the second telephoto unit (the dual camera bit), the 20 MP secondary camera on the OnePlus 5 brings in 1.6x optical zoom to the OnePlus 5. With as many as 20 megapixels crammed on 1/2.8-inch sensor with 1.0 µm pixel size, the telephoto performance is somewhat similar to the main camera. Fast and accurate focusing, instant capture and accurate white balance performance. However, the 20MP shots are on the softer side, the f/2.6 lens doesn't help proceedings either, low-light shooting is certainly not its forte and you'd often find excessive noise creeping in. Overall, we'd rate the camera at a 7 on 10.

At 3300 mAh, the battery capacity on the OnePlus 5 hasn't really changed in comparison to the OnePlus 3T, what has though is the SoC. The 10nm based Snapdragon 835 sips lesser battery juice, while running faster and cooler. All of which adds to the overall battery efficiency of the device. Moderate to occasional heavy usage will get you through the day without setting any alarm bells. And, just in case you feel the need for a quick dash of extra juice, the Dash charge tech will ensure you get done with refueling in almost no time.

—Soham Raninga

SPECIFICATIONS

5.5-inch 1080p AMOLED Display with Gorilla Glass protection | Snapdragon 835 SoC | 8GB RAM | 128GB storage | 16MP sensor based f/1.7 main rear camera, 20MP 1.6x telephoto camera with f/2.6 | 3300 mAh battery | Dual SIM 4G | No memory card slot

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